November 8, 2026

Dear Colleagues,

I am writing to physicians and clinic leaders across Ontario who already provide image-guided pain care. Your practices show every day what safe, specialist-led care looks like. I am inviting you to join the Ontario Pain Specialist Association (OPSA), so that together we can make this standard the norm and create real distinction in chronic pain medicine in this province.

Chronic pain is a leading cause of lost work, strained families and diminished quality of life, yet the care patients receive varies widely. You have likely seen the consequences: patients arriving after injections performed without image guidance, or by practitioners without recognized training in pain medicine. Meanwhile, the value of specialist pain care is not always recognized. Patients' experiences rarely inform policy, and the system lacks a connected approach. Strong community-based pain care, close to home, could also ease pressure on our emergency departments and hospitals.

OPSA believes people living with pain can get better. We advocate for specialist-led, image-guided pain care as the standard for every Ontarian. That means:

- **Image guidance:** interventional procedures performed under image guidance, for accuracy and safety.
- **Appropriate training:** procedures performed by appropriately trained pain specialists.
- **Holistic care:** interventions delivered as part of a comprehensive plan that includes medical management, rehabilitation and psychological support where needed.

Working with patients, caregivers, government stakeholders, and health system partners, we champion safe, evidence-based care. Our goal is simple: help people live their best lives with less pain, and return to work, family and community.

Your voice carries weight with patients, policymakers and peers. I am asking you to stand with us in one or more of these ways:

1. **Become a founding member.** OPSA is being incorporated as a membership-funded, not-for-profit corporation under Ontario's *Not-for-Profit Corporations Act, 2010*. Founding members will shape its direction from day one.
2. **Sign on as a supporting clinic, endorsing our position** that specialist-led, image-guided care should be the standard of care in Ontario.
3. **Take on a leadership role.** We are building our board and leads for clinical advocacy, education, membership and community engagement.

4. **Spread the word** among colleagues, residents, fellows and partner specialties, including primary care, who share these values.

A founding financial commitment. OPSA will be funded by its members, not by industry. To launch our work, I am asking each founding member to pay a one-time **initiation fee of $400**, which covers the first month, followed by a **monthly fee on a sliding scale** based on the number of members. Based on 25 founding physicians, the monthly fee is about $290 (see the Appendix). This will fund OPSA's early initiatives, including incorporation, advocacy with government and health system partners, and patient and physician education. Because the cost is shared, each member's contribution will decrease as our membership grows.

Membership registration opens soon. In the meantime, please register your interest at opsa.pages.dev, or reply to me directly.

Ontarians living with pain should not have to wonder whether the care they receive is safe or effective. With your support, OPSA can make specialist-led, image-guided care the expectation rather than the exception.

Thank you for considering this invitation. I look forward to working with you.

With warm regards,

Dr. Zameer Pirani, MD, FRCPC (Anesthesia & Pain Medicine)
Founder & Chair Ontario Pain Specialist Association (OPSA)
piranizameer@gmail.com
519-851-4595

Appendix: Membership fees

All monies collected will go towards OPSA initiatives.

Initiation fee. Each member pays a one-time initiation fee of **$400**, which covers the first month. After that, the monthly physician fee follows the sliding scale below, based on total membership. Our budget is based on 25 founding physicians, or about $290 per month each.

Your monthly share falls as membership grows.

Members	Monthly share per member
10	$720
25 (founding members)	$290
50	$145
100	$75